

Debian 8 'Jessie' released

Debian is a free operating system, developed by thousands of volunteers from all over the world who collaborate via the Internet. After almost 24 months of constant development, the Debian project has presented its new stable version 8

(code named Jessie), which will be supported for the next five years thanks to the combined work of the Debian security team and the Debian LTS (long term support) team. Jessie ships with a new default init system, systemd. The systemd suite provides many exciting features such as faster boot times, cgroups for services, and the possibility of isolating a part of the services.

This release includes numerous updated software packages, such as:

- Apache 2.4.10
- Asterisk 11.13.1
- The GIMP 2.8.14
- An updated version of the GNOME desktop environment 3.14
- GNU Compiler Collection 4.9.2
- Cedove 31.6.0 (an unbranded version of Mozilla Thunderbird)
- Iceweasel 31.6.0esr (an unbranded version of Mozilla Firefox)
- KDE Plasma Workspaces and KDE Applications 4.14.2
- LibreOffice 4.3.3
- Linux 3.16.7-ckt9, and many more

If you want to only try Debian 8 Jessie without installing it, you can use a live image, available for CDs, USB sticks, and netboot set-ups. It is also possible to use these live images to install Debian. More information is available from the Debian Live home page.



A first look at Visual Studio Code for Linux

The BUILD 2015 event took place on April 29, 2015, in which Microsoft had the pleasure of announcing the preview of its Visual Studio Code tool for Linux, OS X and Windows operating systems. According to Microsoft, Visual Studio Code aims to be a powerful and streamlined IDE that lets developers build and debug modern, platform-independent Web and cloud applications, as well as develop Node and ASP.NET apps.

According to the application's website, Visual Studio Code eliminates the need for a complete integrated development environment (IDE) by combining rich code assistance and navigation with a streamlined user interface found on modern editors, and an integrated debugging experience. The program is currently distributed as a ZIP archive that does not require installation. The application has been tested on an Ubuntu 15.04 (Vivid Vervet) machine.

The notable feature in this software is that it uses a sleek dark theme, which is quite useful for developers who spend numerous hours writing code and debugging their applications. A light theme is also available, and the welcome screen will help anyone get started in minutes. The software automatically recognises programming languages and integrates with Git. It currently supports C++, C#, CSS, CoffeeScript, Clojure, Go, HTML, JSON, Lua, Objective-C, PHP, Perl and many other languages.

While not an open source application, Visual Studio Code is free and runs on all mainstream operating systems, including GNU/Linux, MacOS X and Microsoft Windows.

Tor 4.5 now available for GNU/Linux

The Tor project has recently announced the general availability of its open source browser for GNU/Linux and other operating systems including MacOS X and Microsoft Windows.

Tor Browser 4.5 includes Tor 0.2.6.7 with extra patches; obfs4proxy 0.0.5



to enable users to use obfs4proxy for obfs4, obfs3, obfs2 and ScrambleSuit bridges; and an updated Pluggable Transport Dependency. The Tor launcher has been updated to version 0.2.7.4 and includes numerous bug fixes over the 0.2.7.0.2 release used in Tor Browser 4.0.8.

As stated in an announcement, the Tor project will be delaying the automatic update of 4.0 users to the 4.5 series for one week because of some significant features added in the update related to usability, security and privacy enhancements. If you have Tor Browser 4.0.x installed, you can easily update to the new Tor Browser 4.5 by using the built-in update utility. You can also download Tor Browser via Softpedia or directly from the application's website.